

STANDING ORDER NO. 439/2015

OPERATION "NIRBHEEK"

Introduction

It has been seen that offenders in more than ninety percent of the sexual assault cases are relatives, neighbours, friends and acquaintances of victims. And most of the cases take place within the four walls of private spaces like homes and work places. Quite often victims hesitate to come forward to register their cases owing to family and social pressure, social stigma, and lack of trust in the administration of criminal justice system.

The above is invariably the case of innocent young children who happen to be unaware of what constitutes a sexual offence or which touch is good or bad. Owing to their innocence, they fall prey to the lust of a pervert offender, and sometimes become victim of serious crime also.

Through '**Operation Nirbheek**' Delhi Police has taken an initiative to spread awareness in girls'/Co-ed schools to educate girl students about various aspects of sexual offences of which innocently or inadvertently they become victim, to instill confidence in them to report to Police for legal action, and to involve parents and community to win their confidence and seek their participation in handling this sensitive issue. This operation will be launched in each girls'/co-ed school through a designated police officer.

Objectives

Operation Nirbheek will have the following objectives:

- (i) To spread awareness among the girl students about various types of sexual offences they may fall prey to, for example, about a good touch and a bad touch, etc.
- (ii) To interact with the girl students in order to have friendly and participative interaction.
- (iii) To instill confidence in them so that they could share their most personal trauma.
- (iv) To identify the victim of sexual offences amongst the girl students.
- (v) To convince them to report to police in case they have become victim of sexual offence.
- (vi) To engage parents and community to fight against such crimes.
- (vii) To make the parents and community aware that if they do not come forward to take action against sexual offenders owing to social stigma, their action would embolden these offenders to commit major crimes.

Team for Operation Nirbheek

- (i) ACP sub-division will be the overall incharge of Operation Nirbheek in his sub-division, assisted by SHO who will be the Chief Coordinator. W/SI or ASI of Police Station will be the coordinator, and W/HC or Constable will be the 'Nirbheek Woman Police Officer (NWPO).
- (ii) SHO shall select a courteous, disciplined upper or lower subordinate woman police officer as 'Nirbheek Woman Police Officer' for each girls'/Co-ed school under his jurisdiction.
- (iii) 'Nirbheek Woman Police Officer' (NWPO) should have good communication skills, patience, listening capability, and interest to work with children.
- (iv) She should be well dressed while visiting her allocated school.
- (v) She will wear an arm band with 'Nirbheek' written on it during her visit to school.
- (vi) SHO shall have a system of keeping substitute women staff in case the NWPO is on leave or unwell.

Duties of SHO (the chief coordinator of the 'Operation Nirbheek')

SHO will perform the following duties:

- i) He will contact the Principal/Administrator of the girls' /Co-ed Schools under his jurisdiction and explain them the objectives of 'Operation Nirbheek', and seek their active cooperation.
- ii) He will introduce the NWPO to the Principal/Administrator of the girls'/Co-ed schools, and request them to allocate a fix time of atleast two hours once a week, and a suitable place where the NWPO could interact with the girl students, and also a place to hang Nirbheek Complaint Box in each school.
- iii) SHO will get a '**Nirbheek Complaint Box**' made for each girls'/Co-ed School. It will be a wooden or an Iron letter Box of uniform size with proper lock and will have 'Nirbheek Complaint Box' plus the telephone number of NWPO in bold letters painted on it.
- iv) SHO will take legal action on the complaints or the information brought by the NWPO, after taking the victim and her parents in confidence.
- v) SHO will interact with the parents and community leaders if they are reluctant to take legal action against the sexual offender even after a girl gathers courage to come forward and reports to Police.
- vi) SHO will coordinate with the earmarked NGO of the district, DSLSA and CWC in case counselling, legal, and financial assistance are required for the victim.

Duties of Nirbheek Woman Police Officer (NWPO)

NWPO will perform the following duties:

- i) She will visit the allocated girls'/Co-ed School on a pre-decided day and time, and interact with girl students at an earmarked briefing place. She will start her session with discussing subjects of general nature.
- ii) She will encourage participative interaction, and allow the girls to express freely and unhesitatingly.
- iii) She will listen to them patiently and try to gauge if a girl wants to say something but hesitates to express freely and confidently. She will identify such girl and spend more time with her to know her problem, and encourage her to express her grievances.
- iv) After reaching a comfortable level of friendly interaction, she will broach upon the topics of physical abuse and violations, sexual harassment, good touch and bad touch. She will brief them about physical and mental violence and sexual offences.
- v) She can use various mediums for example, group plays, projector shows, Natak, speech by the participating girls, etc., to convey her message.
- vi) She can ask one of the victims present in the gathering to tell her success story.
- vii) With the help of ACP and SHO she will collect copies of various educational films on this topic for example, 'Komal (produced by Childline India Foundation)', and show to the girl students during her briefing session.
- viii) She will brief them about the Women Helpline (1091), and encourage them to seek help from Delhi Police.
- ix) She will brief them about the 'Nirbheek Complaint Box' and motivate them to drop their complaints, advices, in the 'Complaint Box.'
- x) During each visit, she will open the 'Nirbheek Complaint Box', and take out all complaints from the box and submit to the SHO.
- xi) She will ensure that identity of any complainant or victim is not revealed to anyone and will instill faith in the girls on these lines.

Record Maintenance

1. SHO will maintain two registers as per **Annexure-I**, one for each school, to be maintained by the NWPO of the school, and another to be kept at the Police Station.

2. The NWPO shall write down all verbal and written complaints/suggestions in the register.
3. She will get the endorsement of school principal/Administrator in the Register during her each weekly visit to the school.
4. She will make DD entry regarding her departure and arrival for her visits to the allocated schools.
5. She will make DD entry regarding the complaints, both verbal and written, made to her or dropped in the 'Nirbheek Complaint Box.'
6. She will put up the Register before the SHO after every weekly visit.
7. The coordinator of the scheme, the earmarked W/SI or ASI by the SHO, will prepare a weekly report and submit to the ACP/Sub-division through the SHO. The ACP/Sub-division after recording his observation will submit the same to the District DCP.

Coordination with School and Other Agencies

- i) ACP/Sub-division will coordinate with the Principal/Administrator of girls'/Co-ed School to chalk out a yearly schedule of the NWPO at the beginning of each academic session to ensure that the 'Operation Nirbheek' is carried out smoothly.
- ii) District DCP will take up with the Directorate of Education in case the Principals/Administrators do not co-operate to implement this Operation.
- iii) SHO will involve NGOs, DSLSA, CWC for counselling, legal and financial assistance if required.

Training

ACP/Sub-division will organize training of Nirbheek Woman Police Officer (NWPO) for capacity building in terms of communication skill, art of listening and handling issues related to young girls.

ACP may involve NGOs for organizing these trainings.

Publicity

- (i) DCsP will ensure wide publicity of 'Operation Nirbheek' through various media.
- (ii) He should also make partners in the media for publicity of good work done through this Operation.

Supervision

Besides the day-to-day supervision by ACP/Sub Division and SHO over the Operation Nirbheek, DCP district will closely monitor to ensure that the operation is being implemented on ground properly. He will hold meeting of Operation Nirbheek Team atleast once a month. Joint CP/Ranges will also periodically review the quality of implementation of the 'Operation Nirbheek.'


7/10/2015
(BHIM SAIN BASSI)
Commissioner of Police
Delhi

O.B. No. 41/RB/PHQ

No. 6456-6582/Record Branch/PHQ dated, Delhi the 07-10-2015

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4. All Addl. CsP. Delhi
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6. S.O. to CP/Delhi
7. Addl. DCP/IT Centre/PHQ
8. All ACsP/Inspr. posted in PHQ
9. I/C Library

ANNEXURE-I**OPERATION NIRBHEEK/Register No. 1****(TO BE MAINTAINED BY STAFF VISITING THE SCHOOL)**

Name of School _____ Date _____

Name of Nirbheek Woman Police Officer _____

S.No.	Name of complainant, Age and Class	Gist of complaint (Verbal or written	Remarks

Endorsement by the School
Principal/AdministratorSignature of visiting staff
Name _____**OPERATION NIRBHEEK/Register No. 2****(TO BE MAINTAINED AT POLICE STATIONS BY SHO)**

Name of school _____ Date _____

Name of visiting Officer _____

S.No.	Name of Complainant, Age & Class	Gist of complaint (Verbal or written)	Action proposed to be taken (by SHO)	Name of IO	Remarks by ACP